distance to the hotel site. Alternative B7 Lamar-Commerce does not serve the Convention Center Hotel site.

In order to create a more seamless passenger connection between stations under Alternatives B4 and B4a and the Convention Center Hotel site, a range of at-grade, elevated and below grade connection options were examined. These options would extend along Young Street and include:

- At-grade street and sidewalk improvements designed to create a safe and secure walking environment, to provide visual recognition of a designated pedestrian pathway, and to facilitate the movement of small shuttle vehicles between the Convention Center Hotel and the station;
- An elevated, enclosed pedestrian bridge, with or without an automated moving walkway to increase walk speed; or
- An underground pedestrian tunnel, with or without an automated moving walkway to increase walk speed.

The connection could be a separate project completed by others, or could be incorporated into the project. For the purposes of the D2 study, it is assumed that this connection would be funded by non-DART sources and is not evaluated as part of this AA/DEIS.

2.3 Recommended Alternative

This section discusses the next steps for developing a second transit alignment through downtown Dallas. DART is currently advancing the alternatives analysis/Draft Environmental Impact Statement (AA/DEIS) evaluation process, having completed the Project Scoping, Alternatives Screening and Detailed Definition of Alternatives phases. During each of these phases, the DART Board has made interim decisions, supported by technical analysis and public discussion, which have narrowed the range of alternatives to those presented in this document. This process will ultimately result in the selection of a Locally Preferred Alternative (LPA) for advancement into detailed engineering, final design and construction.

2.3.1 Evaluation of Alternatives

The D2 Alternatives are being evaluated using the methods and criteria for an AA required for participation in the FTA New Starts Program. This DEIS is being conducted on the Alternatives, pursuant to NEPA. The alternatives analysis and environmental impact statement consider the extent to which the Alternatives meet the D2 Study's Purpose and Need and discuss the alternatives' potential effect on transportation and the environment. A financial evaluation compares capital and operating costs, in addition to project affordability given the available funding sources. Public and agency participation in the study is also considered.

2.3.2 Selection of Locally Preferred Alternative

The process for selecting a locally preferred alternative is as follows:

- Project advisory committee meetings, public meetings and presentations to the DART Board were held during May and June of 2009 to present the results of the Preliminary DEIS and gather comments and public input. The meetings and